Cronostasys: The Shatred light

Prologue

The post-war period, a time for peace many would say, but no, the great golden city could be seen for miles, a settlement for the greatest minds the world could bring as the source of eternal peace.

In that city lies the tomb of a great sorceress, endowed with the intelligence to transform that which I study into mechanisms which I call "Techno-Arcane".

In that place an event occurs, a myth for everyone, to see a barely conceivable madness work, to revive a great mind.

That machine, pumping blood throughout the system as if it were barely turned on, allowed us to see the thoughts of the barely awakened Morgana Black, a scientist with a heart of metal created with blood magic.

A single, miserable question came to everyone's mind:

A mechanism made from the discoveries of a... traitor?

Those responsible for setting that machinery in place are among the few who can speak of how a peaceful city was drawn into war time and time again. But one of those few saw it all; someone now witnesses the rebirth of that lady.

The light covered Morgana Black's face, allowing her to see something more.

One night barely halfway through, a fragment of light barely exists in the rawest ruin of the civilization called Ytslialis, its almost perfect shadow always allowed something, to forget an important fact.

Nothing lasts long enough to become that necropolis...

<u>Carta de Morgana Black a Arkhalis Inkdeath</u>

Dear Lady Inkdeath

Who are you really? Are you hiding something beneath that layer of skin and bones?

A normal person doesn't make such violent connections, much less such direct ones to the blood or even to its functioning.

I saw your notes.

Was your mother that crazy woman my sister wanted so much... can I still call that dictator my sister? Do you call her your mother?

It's a question for posterity, I hope.

Sincerely, a stranger to you.

-Dr. Morgana Black

Trail of Ash: Open Eyes

A dazzling light falls upon the face of a dead lady, one whose heart is now nothing more than a bad story told by a tearful eye with blood-soaked hands.

A group of magicians and soldiers with peculiar ideas entered the room of that tomb and quickly inserted a machine with an uncertain result.

A heart made of mechanisms and the magic once called impure. A heart that pumped as if that person were alive, and out of nowhere, their eyes began to move.

???: Gentlemen, our time is limited. Lunariaxis will be here in a flash if this continues. Grab her and let's go.

???: Sir, don't you think we're attracting too much attention just by coming in here? I think you should start calling for reinforcements. I'm starting to think they're planning an attack by that madman.

As they continued their journey through those corridors, blood and tears covered some walls, and tears covered the face of the barely awake lady.

With the feeling of that machine penetrating the fine threads that make up the flesh, she began to cry, a torture barely imaginable for those who transport her.

But the only important thing... she's alive to see what became of her legacy.

When that group managed to get below deck, they heard the cold sound of footsteps in the corridors; they truly made a loud noise, a sign of their dominance.

???: Anton, searching for Lady Black this way might not have been the best idea; at this point, you must be searching room by room and she still hasn't gotten up.

Anton: Well, it's now or never, the escape of the beloved girl from that "leader" we now call a true traitor, I leave you with the attention to the details, fatal and even somewhat sad, perhaps we can settle somewhere under this... building.

Anton, a name remembered for being the respected big-city general of EldenHeaven, one that everyone respected and who lived for war, but even his own ambitions took him very far.

In the eyes of anyone, and especially of his country, perhaps too much so, until finally leaving the lands that once called calm to be a place of tears.

Morgana's eyes opened suddenly, filled with fine tears that covered her face in threads, and even blood oozed from her eyes.

That device was installed correctly and managed to keep her alive, even more alive and better than before she lost her own flesh and blood.

The eternal lethargy of the lady who invented the modern world finally came to an end; before them loomed the sister of the dictator of EldenHeaven, Morgana Moebius Black.

The first thing I manage to do is move my mouth, without making any kind of sound and with pain in my throat.

I slowly manage to utter a simple... why?

The answer was given in his native language, a rough but clear agatho.

“Welcome to life, you might not want to see it”

Trace of the Ashes: With Half-Truths.

After a while, he managed to get up, and Morgana quickly noticed how he could barely walk. Anton himself helped him move to some nearby stairs. The soldiers' weapons sounded in the distance; apparently, one of the many conflicts between the officers and the local mafias had started nearby. They were in a bad place at the worst possible time.

As they descended, they followed some barely visible paths and finally arrived at a place beneath his tomb with the symbol of the moon split in two and light arriving from torches of blue fire, something extremely rare.

A huge, visible sign displayed the name of the group that met there:

“The Midnight Order”

When I managed to speak a little, my voice broke; the trace of that still hurts.

Morgana: I...or I don't understand anything

Anton: Don't worry too much for now. My name is Anton, by the way. Take your time to recover; at the end of the day, less than an hour ago, you were dead. Blood magic works true miracles.

Morgana: Blood magic?... Did they use blood magic on me?

Anton: Don't play the moralist, much less someone who follows the rules set by the academy. We know about your games with the void, but everyone here plays with it, so it doesn't matter. At least live to make your sister reconsider.

Morgana: Reconsider? But she's in her right mind.

Anton: You haven't seen the world recently, it's been over three hundred years. It's become like Kayn Black, if not worse.

A Morgana, broken by grief, walks through the halls of what was once a memorial to the kingdom of roses. The tears that flowed from that lady's eyes were memorable, tears trying to deny reality.

When she grabbed a recent newspaper, she burst into tears, now of pain, the greatest pain she had ever felt for something that wasn't even really her fault.

Such a simple headline, such a clear message.

“Yatsure Neeko has risen to power. Now she will guide us through the difficult conflict with Lord Mephisto Eos.”

With notes full of sensationalism and destruction of reality, an unwary reader quickly falls into those clichés and the tears of something past.

The fall of some is great...

Could her sister's be stopped?

News clipping from “The Elden” newspaper

Grand opening of the medical center with the techno-arcane core created by Morgana Black in her lifetime!

Last Thursday, March 21st, we had the great pleasure of witnessing Dr. Morgana Black's last wish for all of us.

The techno-arcane core is officially a renewable energy source for EldenHeaven and Ytse. The luxurious Black Hospital was the first to install this massive machine for public use.

With 30 hours of operation already, it has generated enough energy for the rest of the month, a feat to remember for all of us.

With this grand event we inaugurate the 600th anniversary of Morgana Black's death and the 300th anniversary of Yatsure neeko's reign, formerly known as melia Neeko.

"*We understand your tears better than anyone.*"

-Anton Amadeus BlackWind.

Traces of Ash: Melancholy in Hope

A lady who quickly saw the reality of the world was once the capital of prosperity without conflict.

One who wondered when her sister became a true tyrant, breaking that which once gave shape to her existence.

As time passed, Anton brought him newspapers and the latest news. Seeing how everything evolved because of the machines invented in the past only brought more and more progress along with more conflicts.

Finally, they told him where to sleep, which he couldn't manage. He asked for some thread and newspapers.

I believe a succession of events, searching for the reason behind that conflict; it had lasted so long that the event was forgotten.

The more threads she wove, the more her fragile hands were injured, until she began to find a simple theft, something insignificant and easily recreated. A promise that Morgana herself decided to use as a thank you to that illustrious lady provided a little help in the ruins of the ash.

When I call Anton, he comes with a couple of doctors who voluntarily help Midnight in his attempt to do something for the decadent souls of the golden city.

Anton: Do you need anything, Morgana? Besides some medical treatment as dictated by our... mechanics, your body hasn't moved since the "little problem" in Magnolia.

Morgana: I need some space and an explanation of when this war started. It doesn't make sense why it started... everything is so... strange.

Anton: a story that takes us back to the most advanced laboratories here. Did you know they're also a hospital? To be more specific, the Morgana Black Hospital in the capital.

Morgana: And why is that important?

Anton: Your whole family really likes to interrupt people. Well, that's where the original techno-arcane core was hidden. Mephisto stole it, saying your will said he could use a prototype to make "the thing."

Morgana: That's right. Where is my will?

After a brief explanation from that fine lady, she realized that her will had been destroyed since no one expected it to say anything important because she had bequeathed almost everything to the government of Elden.

Only one person objected; perhaps I could speak with her?

It was a question she couldn't answer in words. That unusual man decided to help her, but Violet wasn't willing to speak out of blind love...

Chapter 1

___Archive___

A Vision of a Mechanical Heart: The Crimson Letter

When he was finally told he could start moving around the place, he naturally didn't hesitate to look for the rose statue, an old place founded by a certain Revery Inkdeath in memory of her former home.

The monument's walls were made of materials native to the city in which it was now trapped. Beautifully decorated and weathered by the passage of time.

As he walked along, he saw that very few people were on the side that seemed obvious to any reasonable person.

“More than rebels, Conscious” was a slogan that was seen everywhere, a way of saying that they had permanently broken free from the cycle of manipulation.

He saw how the machines they used weren't necessarily the most modern, but they were the most useful, how they sent messages through the electrical and lighting networks now called the internet. How everything was a constant political bombardment.

A fragment of that the world became.

But amidst all the chaos, I noticed how there was always a sign, a constant.

A simple “Wanted: Arkhalis Emily Eos Everegarden. Last seen January 12, 1914, Relativity 19”

When she asked if he was part of her family, she immediately knew what to do.

I grab a piece of paper and a pencil and hear a scream from the only blood mage in that place, someone whose gift in the blood was evident and how unhinged she was.

“Arkhalis, O Thank you for freeing us from our condemnation, we are no longer seen as profane. O Great Arkhalis, do not abandon us yet.”

When the lady asked, she looked at her with some confusion.

???: H-hello, miss? I'm sorry, I'm not very good with names.

Morgana: No problem, tell me yours first. You don't seem like a very nice person.

???: Oh, I'm sorry, I get told that often, it's what makes you know so much about blood magic, my name is Beatrice BrokenGlast.

Morgana: I've heard that last name before, someone named Sarín, I don't remember who. He appears in some studies.

Beatrice: Well, maybe my stepsister isn't the nicest to me, but we're on the same path. Wait, are you the scientist they were going to revive with my invention?

Morgana: With the mechanical heart? It's true that it could be improved in some aspects, but it's simply brilliant in many others. Perhaps one day I'll ask you a question or two about your... what do you call it?

Beatrice: It would be a great honor, perhaps at some other time, Morgana Black. Flattering me? It's impossible that that piece of metal actually works.

Morgana: And maybe you need some help with your problem.

Beatrice: Unfortunately, if that's not possible, I'm immune to my medication.

After asking around, I manage with some success to give Anton a letter for that Arkhalis woman. Finding that man is a real achievement if you even manage to

find him; it's been so long that nobody expects anything from him when he makes an appointment, and yet he still arrives on time.

A red letter, written in black ink, for the only family that might speak to him.

Vision of a mechanical heart: The void and its darkness.

Time passed and the traces of that machine stopped throbbing in Morgana, allowing her to analyze the things that were happening in the world.

I seek to investigate more, not to know more but as an escape; with little space to investigate or basically do anything I couldn't make any progress in what I already knew and the new things couldn't give me what I needed to develop it.

A somewhat sleep-deprived Beatrice watched as that lady clumsily tried to use the little space she had.

Beatrice: Excuse me, Miss Black, but there are laboratories further downstairs. They aren't very big, but I think they have enough space for you.

Morgana: Wait, how do they have enough space here for laboratories? These are simple tunnels; soldiers can barely fit through when bringing in supplies.

Beatrice: Yes, well, we noticed that at the beginning, there is a small drop, we created tunnels from my machines with which to have a little space for housing and other needs.

Morgana: Well, can you take me there? If I don't see how to get there, no problem.

A Beatrice who points shrinks a little, points in a direction: this way Miss Morgana.

The tunnels grew older as they progressed, filled with details and even tombs of the people who lived in the ancient Kingdom of Roses.

When they reached the staircase, they saw hundreds of people interacting; the laboratories weren't particularly large, so they quickly settled into them.

In the past, Morgana was known for going against profaned magic in a total way.

Beatrice tried to respect Morgana's ideologies, but when Morgana spoke, she was perplexed.

"Void magic, that stuff is incredibly unstable, so I started investigating it. Blood magic seemed profane to me, but from what I've seen, it isn't. Who knows, maybe void magic isn't either."

Hundreds of vacuum-formed machines absorb everything around them. Watch as each system breaks down, it's like magic throughout the laboratory. Most of the people inside wore special suits because they couldn't withstand the force of the fields.

A crime in plain sight for anyone who knows even the slightest bit about magic. An embodiment of emptiness, fragmented yet ordered in Beatrice's eyes.

He quickly began to formulate things, to find problems in the designs already created until he collided with reality and realized it.

Perhaps I understood the emptiness too naturally; I noticed how it only left shadows in its wake, so I illuminated them with a light.

He couldn't describe what he saw, but someone else had done so before...

Vision of a metallic heart: Aegleeker's theorem.

Nicolai Aegleeker, a brilliant scientist, created what is the greatest magical enigma in history.

What happens if two different points which have the same energy in inverse powers meet at a point?

This phenomenon discovered near Yggdrasil was called "Requiems Aegleeikos" and it consists of equal and opposite forces which create a void hole, a Morgana

theorem that she understood like the back of her hand and which she explained to a Beatrice who was surprised to have never heard of that information.

Beatrice: It's complicated. How was this even formulated, and when?

Morgana: Around 1899, in the first cycle, Aegleeker's idea for creating something unusual is believed to be the result of some primitive books of magic which presented ideas with what we now call the void. A force that is both positive and inversely opposed to an equal counterpart.

Beatrice: That means if two equivalently opposite points collide, a non-equivalent hole opens up, or am I missing something?

Morgana: No, in fact, that's exactly what happens. We call that phenomenon the void. It's complex how she realized from the beginning how it was generated, and it doesn't help to use such ambiguous terms. There are records of some magicians managing to control this force without an initial catalyst.

Morgana was impressed by the mere fact that they began to think of all the possible endings to that.

Beatrice is truly brilliant, and the impression only improved when, in a flash, she ignited two of the machines simultaneously, and how she kept them under control escalated to such a point that the energetic force was almost immeasurable.

A force A that is equal and opposite to a force B.

She understood the theorem so well that she created a strange rift from which emerged someone she had perhaps never seen except in photographs.

Just a vision of a deceased woman during magnolia season.

The scream caught the attention of the entire laboratory, which was full of astonished people.

Beatrice deciphered Aegleseerk's Theorem, and someone else did too, simultaneously.

A Vision of a Metallic Heart: The Archive and Its Implications

The simple, undeniable fact of the theorem behind it led to a paradox.

In a desperate attempt to gain allies, Anton proposed stealing the data from the Archive and, along with that, handing the information over to Mephisto Eos.

The file was the basic name for Elden's main servers during the magical age, as Morgana learned to use modern technology she noticed she could create remote access.

With this and Beatrice's help, they tried to create systems that would prevent direct confrontation with the staff who were barely willing to rebel against Elden.

It soon became a success.

Droids, unmanned machines that could be operated with magic, were quickly put to the test with enormous success. Now it was time to put their success to the test.

Twenty machines, specialized in simply holding out, had already set in motion what they hoped would be a joy. An assault on an area whose greatest achievement was being the site of the next great conflict. One they could never replicate.
Their arrival at the archive was seen with weapons and blood which quickly turned the walls red, what was once frightening as soldiers of an army infinitely more powerful than the rest became fragile in a snap.
A constant assault of machines that didn't even receive real damage until greater security appeared... the guards of a political leader of Elden who could barely handle one machine before dying.
As they got closer to the core, they began stealing all the data they could until everything spiraled out of control.

Facing reality and war: The burning of knowledge.

Burning to the wind, each machine moved files until it found everything worthwhile; some were burned after being scanned.

It wasn't long before they started hearing gunshots outside; the guard arrived much sooner than expected, and Mephisto himself had arrived to try to stop things as quickly as possible and take the information away.